



Microsoft Defender for Containers in AKS



- Microsoft Defender for Containers is part of Microsoft Defender for Cloud, formerly known as Azure Security Center and Azure Defender. It became a multi-cloud solution
- It provides runtime protection for Kubernetes clusters and containerized applications against potential threats such as malware, vulnerabilities, and suspicious activities
- Users can receive security insights and alerts, view security recommendations and configurations, and enable real-time threat protection
- Hardening involves regular evaluation of cluster configurations and providing security recommendations when misconfigurations are discovered
 - Control plane recommendations are available by default at no extra cost for any AKS cluster with Defender Plan enabled
 - Kubernetes data plane level recommendations require Azure Policy add-on and can enforce best practices for future workloads



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- Runtime protection and threat detection offer real-time threat prevention and alerts for suspicious activities
 - Control plane related protection is agentless and by default enabled at no cost with Defender Plan
 - Workload related protection requires Defender profile enabled. Alert examples include creating a pod in kube-system and deleting history commands on a node
- **Summary:**
 - Hardening = security recommendations
 - Runtime protection and threat detection = security alerts
 - Defender plan:
 - Control plane recommendations
 - Control plane alerts
 - Defender profile:
 - Workload alerts
 - Azure Policy:
 - Data plane recommendations